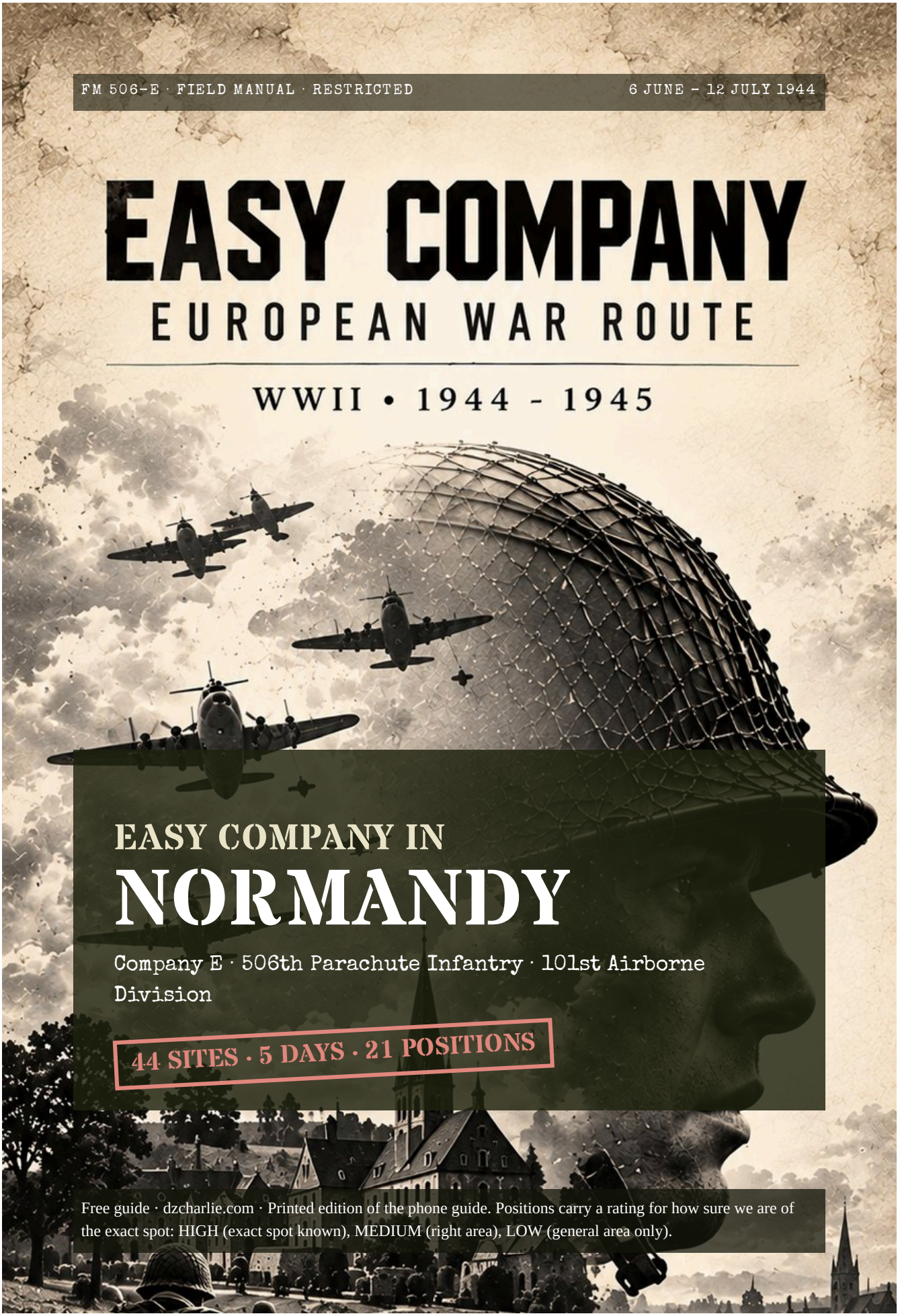
FM 506-E · FIELD MANUAL · RESTRICTED 6 JUNE – 12 JULY 1944

EASY COMPANY

EUROPEAN WAR ROUTE

WWII • 1944 - 1945



EASY COMPANY IN NORMANDY

Company E · 506th Parachute Infantry · 101st Airborne Division

44 SITES · 5 DAYS · 21 POSITIONS

Free guide · dzcharlie.com · Printed edition of the phone guide. Positions carry a rating for how sure we are of the exact spot: HIGH (exact spot known), MEDIUM (right area), LOW (general area only).

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THE STORY IN BRIEF

This guide follows Company E, 506th Parachute Infantry, from the night drop of 6 June 1944 to the ship home on 12 July. Two sets of positions are kept apart on purpose:

TIMELINE — 21 historical positions in date order: what happened, where and when. **TOUR** — 32 stops in driving order across five days: where to go, for how long, and where to sleep. Every stop opens directly in Google Maps.

The night drop. Easy Company entered Normandy in fragments. Cloud, flak and evasive flying broke up the C-47 formations and most sticks landed far from Drop Zone C near Sainte-Marie-du-Mont. Stick 66 never delivered its men: the aircraft carrying company commander 1st Lt. Thomas Meehan, 1st Sgt. William Evans and fifteen others was hit by flak and crashed near Beuzeville-au-Plain — all aboard were killed. Easy went into battle without its commander.

Assembly. 1st Lt. Richard Winters, the executive officer, came down alone somewhere west of Sainte-Mère-Église — he could never say exactly where — without his weapon. He gathered scattered men, moved round the north of the town, fell in behind Lt. Col. Cole's 502nd group, searched La Herguerie farm and reached the 2nd Battalion assembly area at Le Grand Chemin by morning — now the senior Easy officer present.

Brécourt Manor. Sent to silence a four-gun 105 mm battery believed to be firing on Utah Beach, Winters led about a dozen men in an assault often cited as a model of small-unit tactics: a base of fire, a covered approach along the hedgerow, into the trench system, and the guns reduced one by one. Reinforced by Lt. Speirs's D Company men, they destroyed the guns and withdrew.

South to Carentan. First night at Culoville near the regimental CP. 7 June: Easy on point into Vierville against German paratroopers. 7–10 June: reserve at Angoville-au-Plain. 11 June: past Dead Man's Corner, across the flooded Douve causeway and into the marsh fields. 12 June: into Carentan on the Route d'Auvers, fighting to the railway — Winters wounded in the shin. 13 June: the German counterattack at Bloody Gulch, held on the right flank until 2nd Armored tanks arrived.

The long June. Reserve in Carentan under Lt. Welsh while Winters recovered; patrols (Blithe badly wounded — his Purple Heart is dated 25 June, his 21st birthday, though accounts of the exact day and place vary); in the line until relieved 28 June; "near Cherbourg" 29 June: the division bivouac south of Cherbourg (2nd Battalion at Tollevast). 10–11 July back to Utah Beach to embark; Southampton on the night of 12 July, and by train to Aldbourne. Ambrose counts 65 casualties from a company of about 140.

THE ACCURACY RULE

A GPS coordinate can locate a museum, memorial or town precisely; it cannot turn uncertain wartime evidence into an exact landing point. Winters himself could not identify his landing spot, so this guide never invents one. Each position carries a coloured label:

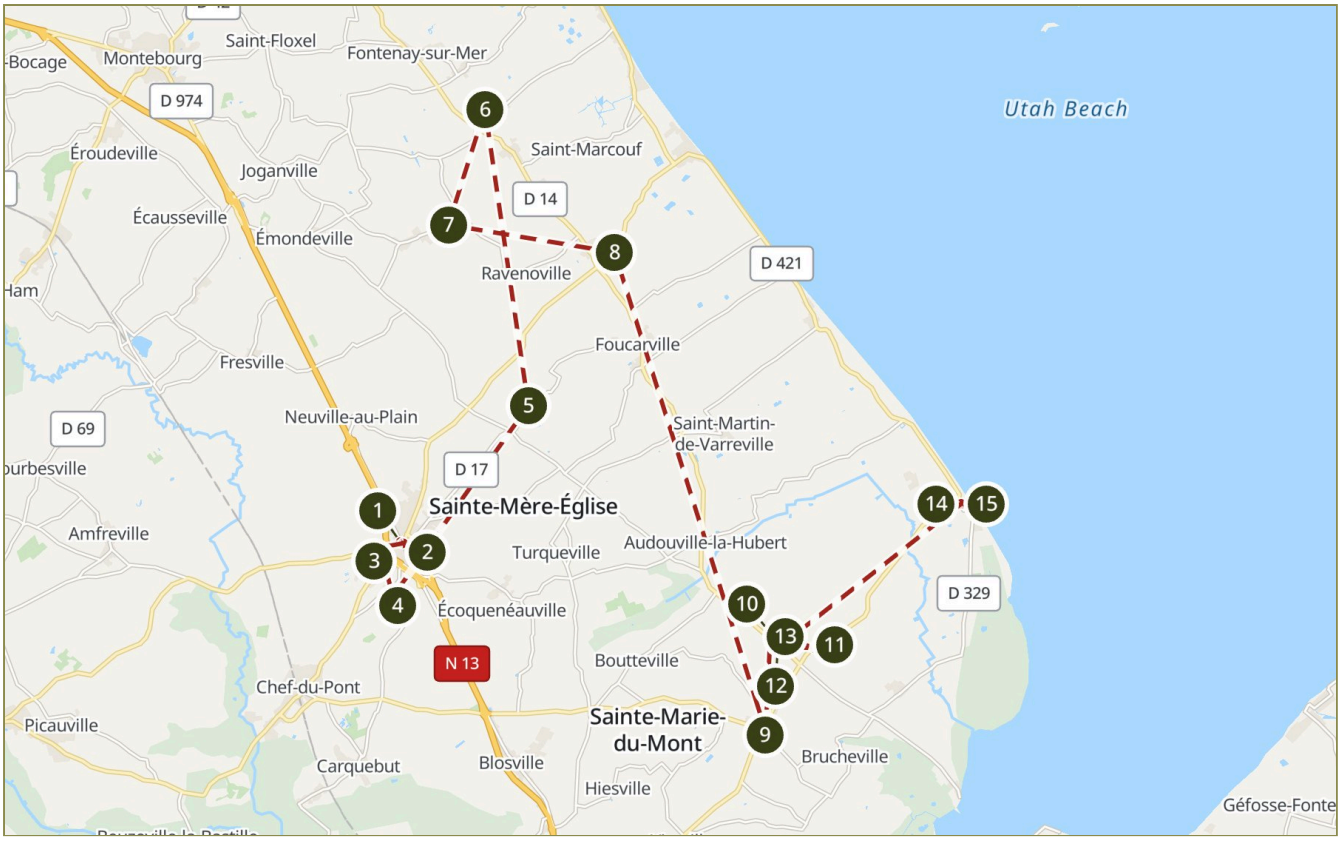
HIGH exact spot known — a landmark, museum, memorial or town MEDIUM well supported, but the exact spot is uncertain LOW general area only — the pin is the centre of a search area

HIGH exact spot known — a landmark, museum, memorial or town MEDIUM well supported, but the exact spot is uncertain LOW general area only — the pin is the centre of a search area

WHY THE WIDER TOUR

Days 3–5 step outside the company to see the machine it was part of: Omaha and Pointe du Hoc, the Atlantic Wall at Longues, the Mulberry harbour, Caen, and the British airborne flank — where the Merville Battery assault is the direct twin of Brécourt.

DAY 1 — THE NIGHT DROP TO UTAH



1 Sainte-Mère-Église
2 Airborne Museum, Sainte-Mère-Église
3 Landing/scatter area — Winters
4 Landing/scatter area — Sticks 68–71 sector
5 Lt. Thomas Meehan / Stick 66 C-47 Memorial
6 Crisbecq (Marcouf) Battery
7 Azeville Battery
8 Ravenoville / Marmion Farm area
9 Sainte-Marie-du-Mont
10 2nd Battalion 506th CP — Le Grand Chemin
11 Richard D. Winters Leadership Monument
12 Easy Company / 506th Brécourt Memorial
13 Brécourt Manor battery area
14 Utah Beach Landing Museum
15 Utah Beach

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Airborne drops → Easy Company → Brécourt → Utah · 13 stops · ~7 h 10 m of visits

The core Easy Company day: from dispersion and the loss of Lt. Meehan through Winters's emergence as a leader, ending on the beach whose survival shaped the company's first mission. Start early.

1 Sainte-Mère-Église

HIGH Town · 82nd / dispersion context · ≈45 min

Begin in the square before the museum. The church and compact street plan make this one of Normandy's strongest orientation points for the airborne landings. Chiefly an 82nd Airborne story, but for Easy it shows the scale of the night-drop chaos.

What you can see: Look at the distances on your map rather than searching for an Easy plaque. The lesson is dispersion.

Plan: Always open. Best 08:00–09:30 or after 18:00.

GPS 49.40890, -1.31810

Read more: Airborne Museum (official) · Wikipedia: Sainte-Mère-Église · Wikipedia: Mission Boston (82nd drop)

2 Airborne Museum, Sainte-Mère-Église

HIGH Museum · ≈120 min · ★ must see

Reconstruct what happened before any Easy man touched French soil: overloaded C-47s, darkness, flak, jump lights, static lines and landing alone. Aircraft, glider, uniforms and equipment make it physical.

What you can see: Give special attention to the C-47 and 101st interpretation — the best place to understand what a 'stick' meant.

Plan: Sep 09:30–18:30 · May–Aug 09:00–19:00 · Apr 09:30–18:30 · Oct–Mar 10:00–18:00 · closed Dec–Jan. Arrive at opening.

GPS 49.40870, -1.31740

3 Landing/scatter area — Winters

LOW Easy Company · Timeline 1 · ≈20 min

Winters's probable landing sector west of town, not a surveyed touchdown point. He came down separated from his company and without his weapon.

What you can see: Stand quietly and imagine the same fields in darkness. The absence of a monument is part of the experience.

GPS 49.40800, -1.32330

4 Landing/scatter area — Sticks 68–71 sector

LOW Easy Company · ≈20 min

A dispersion lesson, not four exact landing sites. Men landed across a broad area and assembled in improvised groups; the company that fought on 6 June was not the one that boarded in England.

What you can see: Compare the plotted points with the intended DZ C to grasp how much cohesion had to be rebuilt on the ground.

GPS 49.40000, -1.32000

5 Lt. Thomas Meehan / Stick 66 C-47 Memorial

HIGH Memorial · Easy Company · ≈30 min · ★ must see

C-47 42-93095, carrying Lt. Meehan, 1st Sgt. Evans and 15 other Easy paratroopers, was hit by flak and crashed near Beuzeville-au-Plain. All five aircrew and 17 paratroopers were killed.

What you can see: Unlike the scatter pins, this marks a documented crash-site vicinity. The story of Winters's leadership begins partly here.

GPS 49.43131, -1.28579

6 Crisbecq (Marcouf) Battery

HIGH D-Day · Battery · German coastal artillery · ≈60 min

Heavy 210 mm naval battery that dueled with the fleet off Utah and was not taken until 12 June. Shows the scale of gun the Brécourt battery was a small cousin of.

What you can see: Casemates and museum north of Utah Beach.

GPS 49.47992, -1.29672

7 Azeville Battery

HIGH D-Day · Battery · German coastal artillery · ≈60 min

Four casemates linked by tunnels, painted to look like houses; fired on Utah and held out until 9 June.

What you can see: Walkable tunnels; pair with Crisbecq.

GPS 49.46100, -1.30600

8 Ravenoville / Marmion Farm area

MEDIUM Easy Company · ≈30 min

Associated with a separated Easy group — Guth, Talbert, 'Smokey' Gordon and Tipper. Small groups formed from whoever was nearby, fought local actions and moved toward friendly objectives.

What you can see: Read the hedgerows and farm lanes. Do not enter private fields or farm property.

Plan: Private land — view from the road.

GPS 49.45650, -1.26400

9 Sainte-Marie-du-Mont

HIGH Town · 506th sector · Timeline 7 · ≈45 min

The heart of the 506th's D-Day sector, connecting the landings, the routes to Utah and the Brécourt action. From here the scattered story converges.

What you can see: Use the village and its church tower as your geographic reset.

GPS 49.37780, -1.22580

Read more: Wikipedia: Sainte-Marie-du-Mont · US Army CMH: Utah Beach to Cherbourg

10 2nd Battalion 506th CP — Le Grand Chemin

HIGH Easy Company · Timeline 5 · ≈20 min

In this area Winters reached the battalion CP, was drawn into the leadership vacuum and received the mission that led to Brécourt. Interpretive reconstruction, not a marked footprint.

What you can see: The hinge in the story.

GPS 49.39400, -1.22460

11 Richard D. Winters Leadership Monument

HIGH Memorial · ≈20 min · ★ must see

Winters stands for the junior officers who led on D-Day. Not a combat position, but its placement on the road to Utah makes it an effective pause before Brécourt.

What you can see: Look past the statue to the flat farmland and hedges: visibility could collapse within metres in the bocage.

GPS 49.39151, -1.21349

12 Easy Company / 506th Brécourt Memorial

HIGH Memorial · public viewpoint · ≈30 min · ★ must see

The practical public viewpoint for the Brécourt story. Orient toward the private battery area; the guns were believed to be firing toward Utah Beach.

What you can see: Stay on public access. Use the memorial to identify the participants, then read the ground.

GPS 49.39172, -1.22273

13 Brécourt Manor battery area

HIGH Easy Company · Timeline 6 · ≈45 min · ★ must see

Winters led a small force against four gun positions: suppressive fire, movement by small groups, into the trench, guns taken in sequence. Four questions to answer on site — where is the covered approach? where can a base of fire suppress? how does the trench connect the guns? why attack sequentially, not frontally?

What you can see: Private property. Understand the geometry from legal viewpoints, not by standing on a supposed gun pit.

Plan: Private land — view from the road.

GPS 49.39161, -1.22247

14 Utah Beach Landing Museum

HIGH Museum · ≈105 min · ★ must see

The other half of the D-Day story: while the airborne secured exits inland, troops and vehicles came through a vulnerable beachhead. Landing craft, vehicles and a B-26 bomber.

What you can see: After Brécourt, focus on the maps of beach exits and artillery threats — the reason for the assault becomes clear.

Plan: May–Sep 09:30–19:00 · Oct–Apr 10:00–18:00 · tickets close 1 hr before. Best at opening or from 15:30.

GPS 49.41520, -1.17640

15 Utah Beach

HIGH Beach · Timeline 20 · ≈45 min · ★ must see

Finish on the sand. The westernmost landing beach, whose success depended on forces inland. Easy's Normandy campaign also ended here — it embarked from this beach on 10–11 July.

What you can see: Walk from the dunes to the water, then turn inland. Sea → land is the right way to close the day.

Plan: Always open. Best early morning, low-to-mid tide.

GPS 49.41520, -1.17640

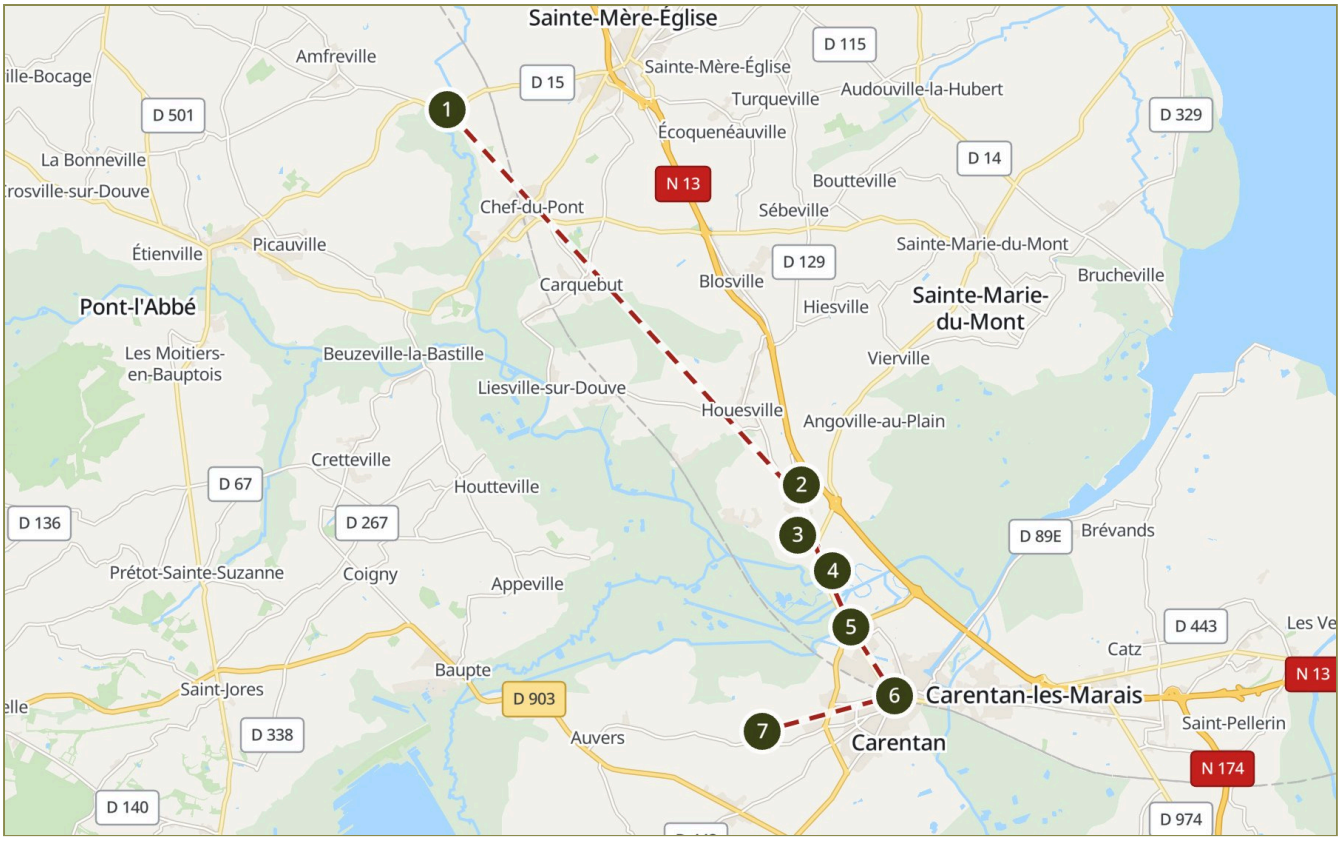
Read more: Utah Beach Museum (official) · Wikipedia: Utah Beach · US Army CMH: Utah Beach to Cherbourg

End of day 1 — overnight: Carentan-les-Marais / Sainte-Mère-Église sector

Aire Camping-Car Park de Carentan, Le Port · 30 chemin du Grand Bas Pays, 50500 Carentan-les-Marais

12 pitches · 24/7 year-round · water, electricity, grey-water & cassette dump, Wi-Fi · 500 m from centre · GPS 49.30909, -1.23910

DAY 2 — THE ROAD TO CARENTAN



1 La Fière Bridge & Causeway
2 St-Côme-du-Mont
3 Dead Man's Corner / D-Day Experience
4 Douve / Dead Man's Corner sector
5 Purple Heart Lane / Carentan causeway
6 Carentan
7 Bloody Gulch / Hill 30 sector

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Merderet → St-Côme-du-Mont → Carentan → Bloody Gulch · 7 stops · ~4 h 45 m

From scattered parachutists to division-level ground combat. The problem was not distance but movement forced onto raised roads through deliberately flooded low ground. Roads, marshes and hedgerows are the protagonists.

1 La Fière Bridge & Causeway

HIGH 82nd Airborne battlefield · ≈60 min

Not an Easy action but indispensable context: control of the Merderet crossings produced some of the fiercest airborne fighting of the invasion. The causeway shows how flooded lowlands turned a road into a bottleneck.

What you can see: Study bridge, causeway and flood-plain geometry — the same problem returns on the approach to Carentan.

Plan: Always open. Best early or late for low light.

GPS 49.40137, -1.36335

2 St-Côme-du-Mont

HIGH 506th / 101st context · ≈30 min

The 101st pushed through here toward Carentan; the 506th took the village on 8 June while Easy was in reserve. Hedgerows and narrow roads fragmented movement.

What you can see: Short map distances conceal difficult ground. Every hedge a wall, every junction an objective.

GPS 49.33600, -1.27200

3 Dead Man's Corner / D-Day Experience

HIGH Museum · Timeline 11 · ≈90 min · ★ must see

The historic crossroads and museum interpret the fighting round Saint-Côme-du-Mont and the approach to Carentan. Material from Meehan's crashed C-47 has been displayed here. Easy passed this corner on the evening of 11 June.

What you can see: Refresh the 101st-wide picture before the exposed Douve approach.

GPS 49.32870, -1.26880

4 Douve / Dead Man's Corner sector

LOW Terrain · ≈20 min

Waterways, marshes, bridges and raised roads dictated movement. Possession of a junction or causeway mattered far beyond its size on a map.

What you can see: Do not rush. Low wet fields, constrained routes, few alternatives.

GPS 49.32813, -1.26845

5 Purple Heart Lane / Carentan causeway

HIGH 101st context · ≈30 min

The causeway toward Carentan became notorious: troops advancing along it were exposed with no room to manoeuvre. Chiefly a 502nd PIR story, but it is the battlefield Easy moved into.

What you can see: Imagine artillery and machine-gun fire channelled onto a narrow approach with marsh either side.

GPS 49.31470, -1.25940

6 Carentan

HIGH Town · Timeline 13 & 15 · ≈60 min · ★ must see

The prize between the Utah and Omaha lodgements. Easy entered on the Route d'Auvers / Rue Holgate axis on 12 June and fought toward the railway, where Winters was wounded; the company was then billeted here in reserve 13–19 June.

What you can see: Walk the central streets rather than drive them.

GPS 49.30320, -1.24820

Read more: Wikipedia: Battle of Carentan · Normandy Victory Museum

7 Bloody Gulch / Hill 30 sector

LOW Easy Company · Timeline 14 · ≈45 min · ★ must see

On 13 June German forces counterattacked south-west of Carentan. The 506th held until armour arrived. For Easy a test of holding ground, not seizing it. The exact hedgerow line is disputed.

What you can see: Battlefield terrain, not a single-point attraction: hedgerows, folds and restricted sightlines.

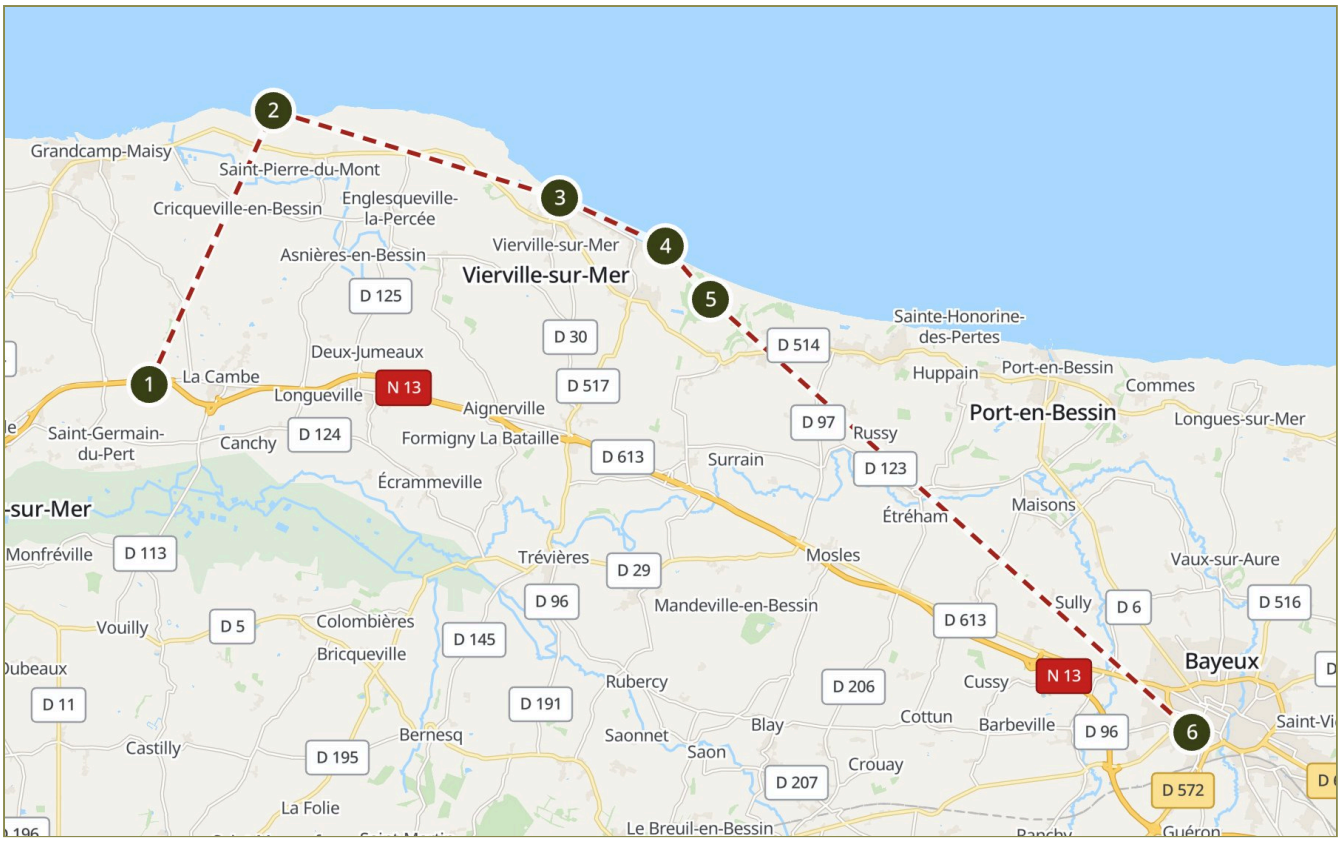
GPS 49.29721, -1.28213

End of day 2 — overnight: Bayeux

Camping des Bords de l'Aure · Boulevard d'Eindhoven, 14400 Bayeux

Full campsite and motorhome pitches · washrooms · service point — the choice when showers matter · GPS 49.28480, -0.69830

DAY 3 — THE AMERICAN INVASION COAST



1 German Military Cemetery, La Cambe
2 Pointe du Hoc
3 Omaha Beach — Dog Green / Vierville
4 Omaha Beach — central sector
5 Normandy American Cemetery
6 Bayeux — Museum of the Battle of Normandy

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

La Cambe → Pointe du Hoc → Omaha → Colleville → Bayeux · 6 stops · ~5 h 30 m

Step outside Easy Company for a day: German dead, the Ranger assault, Omaha's killing ground, American remembrance, and the campaign that followed.

1 German Military Cemetery, La Cambe

HIGH Cemetery · ≈45 min

The day deliberately begins with the German dead — a stark contrast to the American cemetery later, broadening the tour from unit history to the human cost.

What you can see: Place of remembrance. Notice the massing, stone forms and central mound.

Plan: Daytime; visitor centre seasonal.

GPS 49.34250, -1.02690

2 Pointe du Hoc

HIGH Battlefield · ≈75 min

The Rangers' cliff assault was separate from Easy's, but the preserved craters, casemates and cliff edge make the pre-invasion bombardment legible. Same kind of threat as Brécourt, on a larger scale.

What you can see: Walk the cratered ground slowly; the landscape is the exhibit.

Plan: 09:00–17:00 daily (2026) · visitor centre closed from 9 Mar 2026 for restoration. Best 09:00–10:30.

GPS 49.39630, -0.98940

Read more: ABMC: Pointe du Hoc (official) · Wikipedia: Pointe du Hoc

3 Omaha Beach — Dog Green / Vierville

HIGH Beach · ≈45 min

Among Omaha's most punishing sectors. Open sand, limited exits, commanding bluffs — the contrast with Utah explains why the two beachheads developed so differently.

What you can see: Go near the waterline if the tide allows, then turn toward the bluffs. The exposure is the lesson.

Plan: Always open. Best early or 1–2 hr before sunset.

GPS 49.37917, -0.90286

4 Omaha Beach — central sector

HIGH Beach · ≈40 min

A second Omaha stop keeps the beach from collapsing into one viewpoint: compare exits, bluffs and fields of fire across the frontage.

What you can see: Walk inland from the water and identify the draws — routes off the beach, not shoreline distance.

GPS 49.36970, -0.87100

5 Normandy American Cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · ≈90 min · ★ must see

Colleville-sur-Mer turns the battlefield into individual loss; its position above Omaha makes geography and remembrance inseparable.

What you can see: Allow the full time. Move beyond the central axis, read markers, then look back to the sea.

Plan: 09:00–17:00 daily · closed 25 Dec, 1 Jan · last entry 30 min before. Best 09:00–10:30 or the late-afternoon flag ceremony.

GPS 49.35920, -0.85730

6 Bayeux — Museum of the Battle of Normandy

HIGH Museum · ≈105 min

Widens the lens from 6 June to the whole campaign: bocage, attrition, breakout, collapse.

What you can see: Use the maps to place Easy's story inside the larger campaign — you have now seen the ground.

Plan: Seasonal hours; check official site.

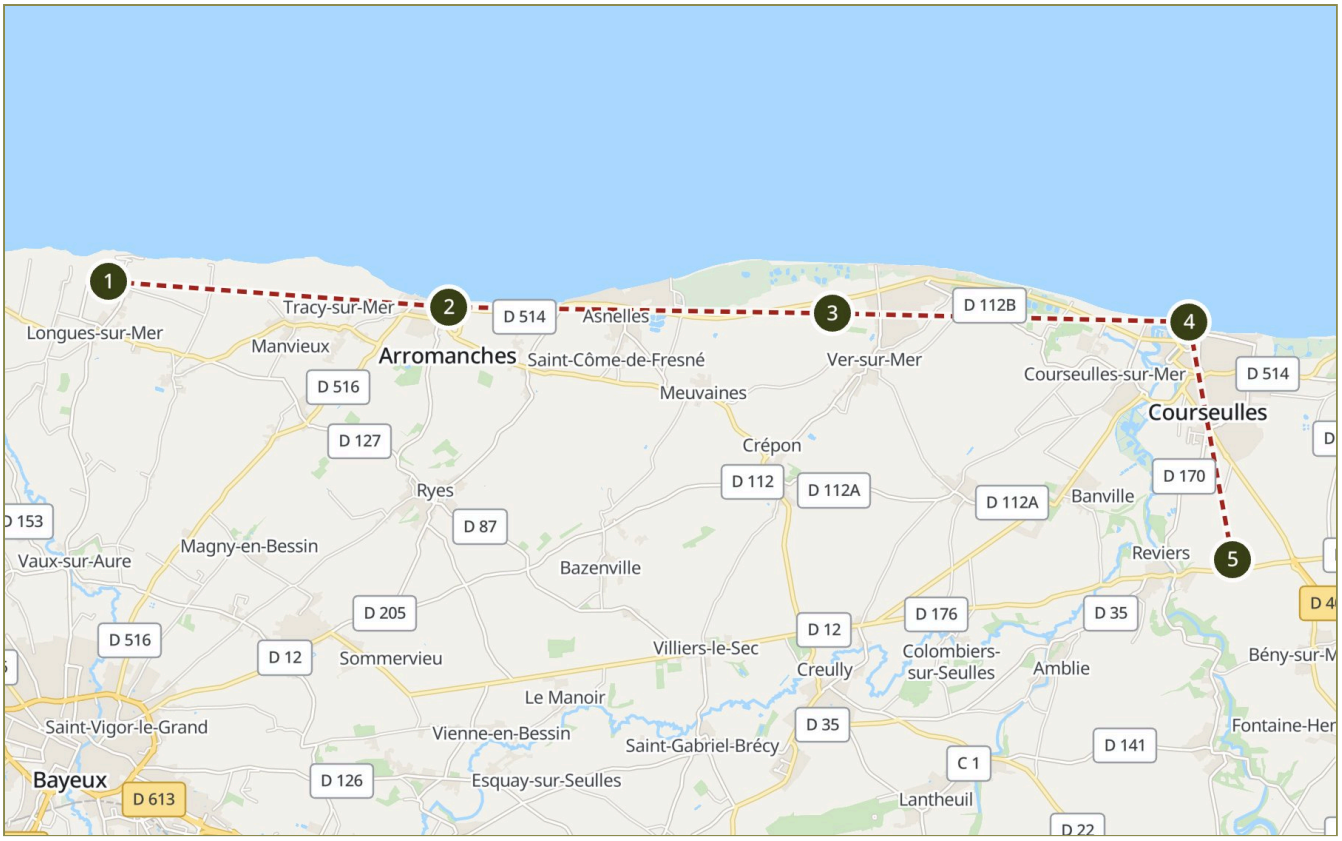
GPS 49.27410, -0.71200

End of day 3 — overnight: Bayeux

Aire de stationnement Bayeux — Trébucien/Verdun · Rue Pierre Trébucien / Rue de Verdun, 14400 Bayeux

25 pitches up to 8 m · all year · electricity, water, dump · no toilets/showers · 10 min walk to centre · GPS 49.27635, -0.71254

DAY 4 — WALLS, HARBOURS & MEMORY



1 Longues-sur-Mer German Battery
2 Arromanches-les-Bains / Mulberry Harbour
3 British Normandy Memorial, Ver-sur-Mer
4 Juno Beach Centre — Courseulles
5 Bény-sur-Mer Canadian Cemetery

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Longues → Arromanches → Ver-sur-Mer · 3 stops · ~4 h 15 m

A deliberately slower day about systems: German coastal defence, Allied logistics, and the human ledger of the British contribution.

1 Longues-sur-Mer German Battery

HIGH Battlefield · ≈75 min

One of the best places to understand the Atlantic Wall as a working artillery system — original guns remain in their casemates.

What you can see: Walk between positions rather than viewing one bunker; the spacing is part of the system.

Plan: Freely accessible; tours seasonal. Best early or late.

GPS 49.34300, -0.69460

2 Arromanches-les-Bains / Mulberry Harbour

HIGH Site · ≈90 min

The logistics story: Port Winston let men, vehicles and supplies flow into Normandy. Read it as a system — offshore Phoenix caissons → floating roadways → shore discharge.

What you can see: View from beach level and from the heights; the harbour only makes sense across the whole bay.

Plan: Viewpoints always open; museum hours separate. Best around low tide, late afternoon.

GPS 49.33940, -0.62070

3 British Normandy Memorial, Ver-sur-Mer

HIGH Memorial · ≈60 min

Brings British and Commonwealth sacrifice into the route, above Gold Beach — Overlord was a coalition operation.

What you can see: A reflective end to the day; the names turn numbers back into individuals.

Plan: Daylight access; verify gate times.

GPS 49.33850, -0.53750

4 Juno Beach Centre — Courseulles

HIGH D-Day · Beach · Canadian 3rd Division · ≈60 min

The Canadians took the heaviest losses of the British beaches in the first hour, then advanced further inland than any other force on D-Day.

What you can see: Canada's museum on the beach; German bunkers in the dunes.

GPS 49.33730, -0.46000

5 Bény-sur-Mer Canadian Cemetery

HIGH D-Day · Cemetery · Reviers · ≈40 min

2,048 Canadian graves from Juno and the fighting for Caen.

What you can see: Quiet, rarely crowded.

GPS 49.30373, -0.45057

End of day 4 — overnight: Caen / north Caen

Aire Camping-Car Park de Caen · Rue des Roquemonts, 14000 Caen

20 pitches · year-round · 100 m from the Caen Memorial · water, electricity, dump, Wi-Fi · GPS 49.19720, -0.38073

DAY 5 — THE EASTERN AIRBORNE FLANK



1 Caen Memorial Museum
2 Pegasus Bridge / Memorial Pegasus
3 Hillman fortress — Colleville-Montgomery
4 Sword Beach — Ouistreham
5 Ranville War Cemetery
6 Merville Battery

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Caen → Pegasus Bridge → Merville · 3 stops · ~4 h 30 m

Close by comparing the 101st's dispersed western drop with the British 6th Airborne's precise glider coup-de-main east of the Orne — and Merville with Brécourt.

1 Caen Memorial Museum

HIGH Museum · ≈210 min

The strategic frame: origins and course of the war, occupation, D-Day and the Battle of Normandy. Deliberately placed late, after four days of terrain.

What you can see: Do not read every label; concentrate on the invasion plan, the campaign and the civilian experience.

Plan: Seasonal; allow 3–4 hr; start at opening.

GPS 49.19790, -0.38470

2 Pegasus Bridge / Memorial Pegasus

HIGH Museum / site · British Airborne · ≈60 min

The glider capture of the Orne and canal bridges was one of D-Day's most precise opening actions — the opposite of the scattered American drop, with the same need to secure crossings and protect a flank.

What you can see: Museum closed 1 Sep 2026 – May 2027; the bridge, canal and approaches remain viewable from public areas.

Plan: Exterior only while closed; best in the morning.

GPS 49.24200, -0.27450

3 Hillman fortress — Colleville-Montgomery

HIGH D-Day · Strongpoint · Sword sector · ≈60 min

The German regimental HQ bunker complex that held up the Suffolks for most of D-Day and helped stop Sword's advance on Caen.

What you can see: Restored bunkers; open on set days.

GPS 49.26528, -0.31003

4 Sword Beach — Ouistreham

HIGH D-Day · Beach · British 3rd Division & Commandos · ≈60 min

Lord Lovat's commandos landed here with a piper playing and marched to relieve Pegasus Bridge by early afternoon. The Grand Bunker — the German fire-control tower — is now a museum.

What you can see: Grand Bunker museum and the Kieffer commando memorial.

GPS 49.28570, -0.25530

5 Ranville War Cemetery

HIGH D-Day · Cemetery · British 6th Airborne · ≈40 min

2,236 graves, mostly of the airborne division, beside the first village liberated by the British.

What you can see: Next to Ranville church; free.

GPS 49.23250, -0.25850

6 Merville Battery

HIGH Battlefield · British Airborne · ≈90 min

The 9th Parachute Battalion attacked this battery despite severe dispersal and lost equipment — the direct parallel to Brécourt. Preserved casemates let you read it from the defender's side.

What you can see: End inside the defensive landscape and compare with Brécourt on Day 1.

Plan: 15 Mar–30 Sep 09:30–20:30 (last 18:30) · 1 Oct–15 Nov 10:00–18:30 (last 17:00).

GPS 49.26940, -0.19650

End of day 5 — overnight: Caen or Ouistreham / onward travel

Aire de camping-cars de Ouistreham Riva-Bella · Boulevard Maritime, 14150 Ouistreham

34 pitches · year-round · electricity, water, toilets, dump, Wi-Fi · near seafront and ferry · GPS 49.28762, -0.24992

WORTH A DETOUR



1 Angoville-au-Plain church
2 Vierville (Cotentin)
3 Normandy Victory Museum
4 Musée Mémorial de Bloody Gulch
5 D-Day Wings Museum

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Extra sites on the Easy Company story, added to the tour when you have more days.

1 Angoville-au-Plain church

HIGH Extra · Timeline 10 · ≈30 min

Easy's reserve sector 7–10 June. The church became an airborne aid station where two 101st medics, Wright and Moore, treated wounded of both sides; the bloodstained pews survive.

What you can see: A small village church — quiet, free, and one of the most moving stops in the Cotentin.

Plan: Free · daylight

GPS 49.34930, -1.25330

2 Vierville (Cotentin)

HIGH Extra · Timeline 9 · ≈20 min

On 7 June Easy led the 2nd Battalion column here on point and met German paratroopers; the village was cleared with support from other 506th elements and armour.

What you can see: Not Vierville-sur-Mer at Omaha. Read the approach lanes from the north.

GPS 49.36110, -1.24530

Read more: Wikipedia: E Company, 506th · US Army CMH: Utah Beach to Cherbourg

3 Normandy Victory Museum

HIGH Extra · Museum, Catz · ≈90 min

Hedgerow fighting and the daily life of soldiers and civilians — the world Easy lived in from 13 to 28 June.

What you can see: Strong on the bocage battle that followed Carentan.

Plan: Between Carentan and Isigny · check hours

GPS 49.30496, -1.19286

4 Musée Mémorial de Bloody Gulch

HIGH Extra · Museum, Méautis · ≈75 min

The fighting after Carentan — the 13 June counterattack Easy helped repel, told from the ground where it happened.

What you can see: Pairs directly with the Bloody Gulch sector stop.

Plan: South-west of Carentan · check hours

GPS 49.29721, -1.28213

5 D-Day Wings Museum

HIGH Extra · Museum, Bretteville-sur-Odon · ≈75 min

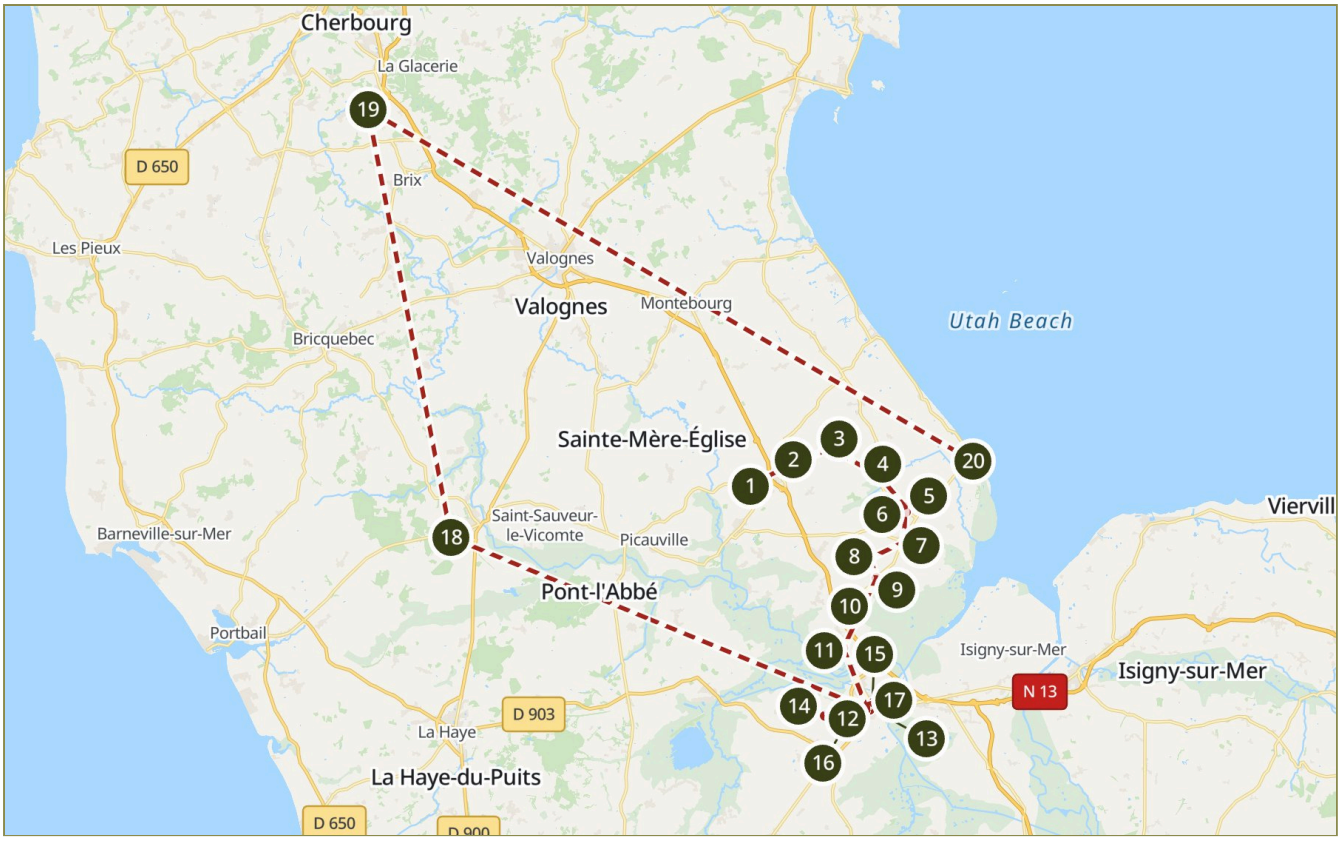
Aviation context — the aircraft and crews that carried the airborne divisions and covered the beaches.

What you can see: Best before the Caen Memorial on the last day.

Plan: West edge of Caen · check hours

GPS 49.17531, -0.44130

THE TIMELINE



1 Winters' probable landing area (reconstruction)
2 Rue Saint-Martin / D423 sector
3 D423 / D115 junction — German column ambush
4 La Herguerie farm, Audouville-la-Hubert
5 Le Grand Chemin — 2/506 assembly / CP
6 Brécourt Manor battery trench line
7 Sainte-Marie-du-Mont sector
8 Culoville / Hiesville — 506th CP area
9 Vierville (Cotentin)
10 Angoville-au-Plain — regimental CP security
11 Dead Man's Corner / St-Côme-du-Mont road
12 South-west approach — jump-off on the Route d'Auvers
13 Carentan — Route d'Auvers / Rue Holgate
14 Donville / Bloody Gulch defensive sector
15 Carentan — division reserve / billets
16 Reconnaissance / patrol sector outside Carentan
17 Carentan defensive / patrol sector
18 Off the line — Saint-Sauveur-le-Vicomte
19 Tollevast — the bivouac near Cherbourg
20 Utah Beach embarkation area
21 Southampton, England — off this map

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

21 historical positions in date order: what happened, where and when. The numbers follow the company's movement.

1 Winters' probable landing area (reconstruction)

LOW 6 Jun 1944 ~01:30 · D-Day movement

Winters landed well off DZ C, west of Sainte-Mère-Église. Some researchers place it near the D15/D17 road junction, but this is a reconstruction, not a settled consensus. Treat the coordinate as the centre of a search area. He oriented himself, gathered scattered paratroopers and moved round the north side of the town toward the 506th objective.

On the ground: Understand how far he landed from the intended drop zone and the difficulty of regrouping at night. No monument — this was confusion across ordinary farmland.

GPS 49.40800, -1.32330

2 Rue Saint-Martin / D423 sector

LOW 6 Jun ~02:30 · D-Day movement

Winters' growing group linked up with Easy men including Malarkey, Guarnere, Toye and Wynn in this road sector, then continued east and fell in behind Lt. Col. Cole's 502nd PIR group.

On the ground: Study the road network and distances; the pin is not an exact meeting point.

GPS 49.41400, -1.30600

3 D423 / D115 junction — German column ambush

MEDIUM 6 Jun ~03:00 · D-Day movement

A German column was ambushed in this junction area. Evidence does not support Winters personally leading the ambush. Afterwards the party continued with Cole's group toward Audouville-la-Hubert.

On the ground: Terrain and context only; exact firing positions are not asserted.

GPS 49.42110, -1.27774

4 La Herguerie farm, Audouville-la-Hubert

MEDIUM 6 Jun pre-dawn · D-Day movement

Winters and the Easy men with him searched the farm while moving toward the 506th assembly area, then returned to the road toward Le Grand Chemin.

On the ground: Rural lanes and hedgerows show the navigation problem before dawn.

GPS 49.40845, -1.24337

5 Le Grand Chemin — 2/506 assembly / CP

HIGH 6 Jun morning · Brécourt & Utah

Winters joined 2nd Battalion elements here. With Meehan missing he was drawn into the leadership vacuum and sent forward to investigate and neutralize artillery firing toward Utah Beach.

On the ground: The hinge of the story: the man who landed alone now has a mission, a handful of men and a concrete threat.

GPS 49.39400, -1.22460

6 Brécourt Manor battery trench line

HIGH 6 Jun ~08:30–noon · Brécourt & Utah

The four-gun battery is firmly identified. Assault from the Le Grand Chemin side along hedgerows and trenches: base of fire, covered approach, into the trench, guns reduced one by one. The force withdrew rather than assaulting the manor. The exact geometry of every gun pit, especially the westernmost, is still debated.

On the ground: Study hedgerows, approach and battery axis from the public memorial. The battlefield is private — do not trespass.

GPS 49.39160, -1.22430

7 Sainte-Marie-du-Mont sector

MEDIUM 6 Jun afternoon/evening · Brécourt & Utah

Easy and 2/506 operated through this sector after Brécourt as airborne and seaborne forces consolidated, then moved south-west toward the battalion/regimental position at Culoville.

On the ground: The village and its church tower are the geographic reset between the inland airborne battlefield and Utah Beach.

GPS 49.37780, -1.22580

8 Culoville / Hiesville — 506th CP area

MEDIUM Night 6–7 Jun · Brécourt & Utah

Winters and Easy spent their first Normandy night here near the 506th command post. At first light Easy was ordered to lead the 2nd Battalion column toward Vierville.

On the ground: Starting point for the 7 June advance south.

GPS 49.37033, -1.24949

9 Vierville (Cotentin)

HIGH 7 Jun ~06:00 onward · Carentan

Easy advanced on point toward Vierville and met resistance from German paratroopers. The village was cleared with support from other 506th elements and armour; movement continued south toward Angoville-au-Plain.

On the ground: This is Vierville in the Cotentin (Manche), not Vierville-sur-Mer at Omaha Beach.

GPS 49.36110, -1.24530

Read more: Wikipedia: E Company, 506th · US Army CMH: Utah Beach to Cherbourg

10 Angoville-au-Plain — regimental CP security

HIGH 7–10 Jun · Carentan

Easy was pulled into reserve and security around Col. Sink's regimental command post while the attack on Carentan was prepared. On the evening of 11 June it rejoined the battalion advance.

On the ground: Visit the church — the airborne aid station where two 101st medics treated wounded of both sides; the bloodstained pews survive.

GPS 49.34930, -1.25330

11 Dead Man's Corner / St-Côme-du-Mont road

HIGH 11 Jun evening · Carentan

Easy passed this landmark moving south toward Carentan; it was not Easy's principal battle site that day. The company crossed the Douve causeway corridor, then left the road and moved across fields toward the south-west approach to Carentan.

On the ground: The constricted road/causeway terrain through the flooded lowlands.

GPS 49.32870, -1.26880

12 South-west approach — jump-off on the Route d'Auvers

LOW Night 11–12 Jun · Carentan

After a night march across the fields by way of Hill 30, Easy reached its jump-off point on the crest of the Route d'Auvers at about 05:30 on 12 June, roughly a hundred yards west of the junction with the road to Périers. From here the company attacked east into Carentan.

On the ground: Visualize the pre-dawn movement from the road network into fields toward Carentan.

GPS 49.30043, -1.25200

13 Carentan — Route d'Auvers / Rue Holgate

HIGH 12 Jun early morning · Carentan

Easy entered Carentan on this axis and fought through the approach and along Rue Holgate toward the railway, building to building. Winters was wounded in the shin near the railway sector.

On the ground: Walk rather than drive the central streets — the major Easy Company urban-combat waypoint.

GPS 49.30085, -1.24975

14 Donville / Bloody Gulch defensive sector

LOW 12–13 Jun · Carentan

Easy dug in south-west of Carentan and held the right flank during the German counterattack of 13 June (17th SS Panzergrenadier and Fallschirmjäger Regiment 6 elements) until armour from the 2nd Armored Division helped restore the situation. The exact hedgerow occupied is disputed.

On the ground: Treat the whole sector as the battlefield, not the pin as a foxhole. Hedgerows and restricted sightlines explain why attacks felt isolated and sudden.

GPS 49.29721, -1.28213

15 Carentan — division reserve / billets

MEDIUM 13 Jun ~23:00 – 19 Jun · Carentan

After the 13 June battle Easy and the 506th were withdrawn into division reserve in Carentan. Winters received treatment; Lt. Welsh temporarily ran the company. Local security, recovery and patrols.

On the ground: Connects the combat phase with the recovery period.

GPS 49.30320, -1.24820

16 Reconnaissance / patrol sector outside Carentan

LOW ≈25 Jun · Later June

Easy conducted reconnaissance and patrol activity; Albert Blithe was seriously wounded on 25 June 1944, his twenty-first birthday. Published accounts do not justify a single exact coordinate for the patrol route.

On the ground: Area reference only.

GPS 49.29000, -1.27000

17 Carentan defensive / patrol sector

LOW 21–28 Jun · Later June

Easy remained in the Normandy line on defensive and patrol duties. Day-by-day company positions are not documented well enough to plot without inventing precision. Relieved from the line on 28 June.

On the ground: Area reference, not an exact position.

GPS 49.30000, -1.25000

18 Off the line — Saint-Sauveur-le-Vicomte

LOW 27–29 Jun · Later June

The division came out of the line at Carentan on 27 June and moved by truck to a bivouac west of Saint-Sauveur-le-Vicomte, where the 506th spent two nights; on 29 June it moved up toward Cherbourg. No exact Easy Company position is recorded.

On the ground: Chronological reference only.

GPS 49.37994, -1.54828

19 Tollevast — the bivouac near Cherbourg

LOW 29 Jun – 9 Jul · Later June

From 29 June the division was in a bivouac area about five miles south of Cherbourg; the 2nd Battalion's was at Tollevast. Training, maintenance, rest, awards and preparation for the return to England. No exact Easy Company tent location is claimed.

On the ground: Approximate area.

GPS 49.57774, -1.60765

20 Utah Beach embarkation area

HIGH 10–11 Jul · Embarkation

Easy moved down to Utah Beach on 10 July to prepare for embarkation; the exact loading point is not established. Departure around 11 July. The historical endpoint of the Normandy ground campaign.

On the ground: Stand on the beach where the company both defended the exits on D-Day and left Normandy five weeks later.

GPS 49.41520, -1.17640

21 Southampton, England

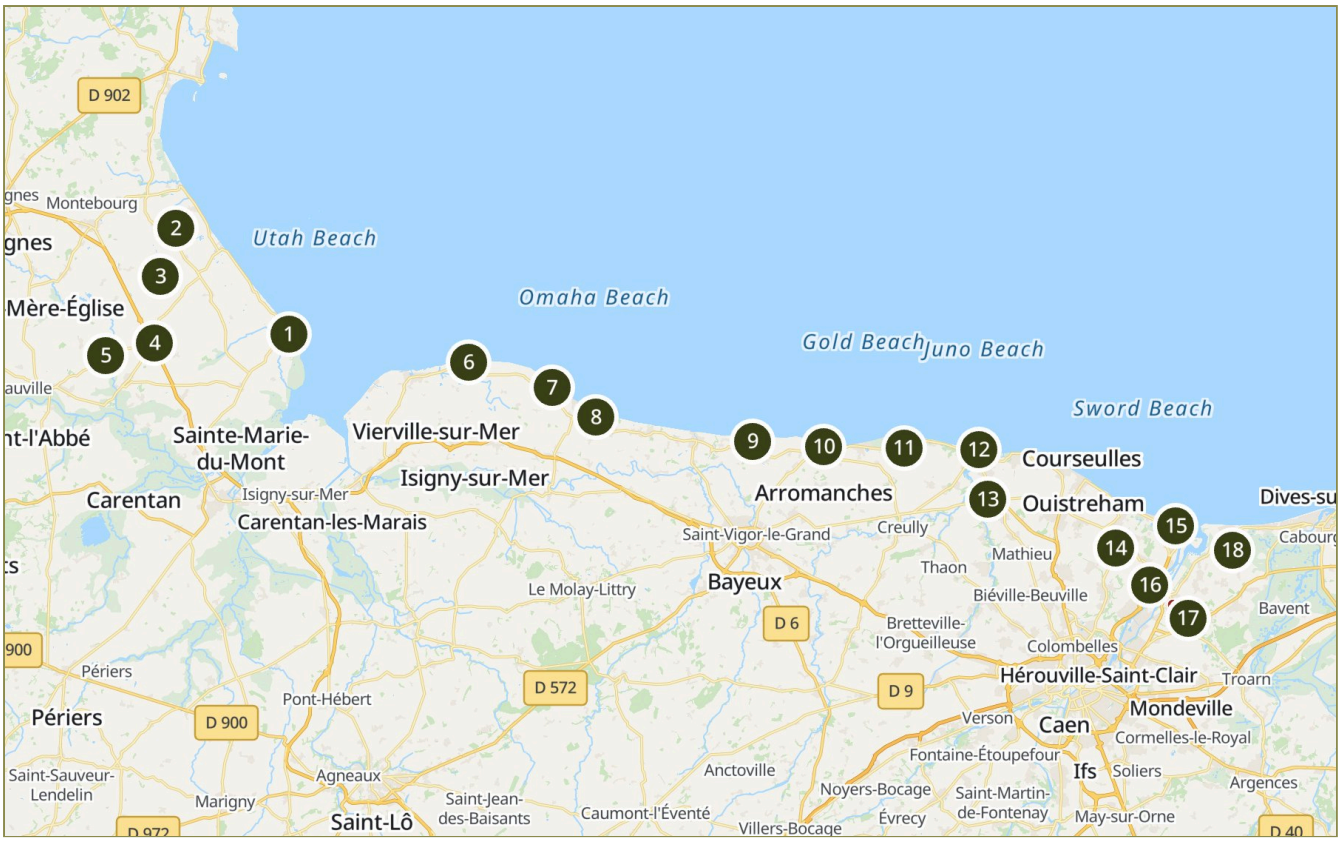
HIGH 12 Jul 1944 · Embarkation

The returning convoy reached Southampton on the night of 12 July; the men went by train to Aldbourne. Outside Normandy — included to close the sequence.

On the ground: Final marker; not on the Normandy driving route.

GPS 50.90000, -1.40000

OPERATION OVERLORD — THE WHOLE INVASION



1 Utah Beach
2 Crisbecq (Marcouf) Battery
3 Azeville Battery
4 Sainte-Mère-Église
5 La Fière causeway
6 Pointe du Hoc
7 Omaha Beach — Vierville draw
8 Normandy American Cemetery
9 Longues-sur-Mer Battery
10 Arromanches — Gold Beach
11 British Normandy Memorial
12 Juno Beach Centre — Courseulles
13 Bény-sur-Mer Canadian Cemetery
14 Hillman fortress — Colleville-Montgomery
15 Sword Beach — Ouistreham
16 Pegasus Bridge
17 Ranville War Cemetery
18 Merville Battery

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

THE DECISIVE FACTORS

The plan — Overlord and Neptune. Five beaches on an 80 km front between the Orne and the Cotentin, three airborne divisions dropped on the flanks before dawn, and a lodgement to be built up faster than the Germans could reinforce it. Neptune was the assault phase; Overlord the campaign to break out of Normandy. Easy's regiment, the 506th, sat at the far western end of the whole scheme, behind Utah Beach. ≈156,000 troops landed on D-Day · ≈7,000 vessels · ≈11,500 aircraft sorties · 5 beaches · 3 airborne divisions

Deception — Operation Fortitude. A fictional army group under Patton in south-east England, dummy landing craft, double agents and false radio traffic convinced German intelligence that the main blow would fall at the Pas-de-Calais. The German 15th Army stayed there for weeks after 6 June — one important reason, alongside German command paralysis, Allied air power and wrecked transport, why the beachhead was not crushed in its first days. German 15th Army held at Calais into July

Weather — the 24-hour postponement. Planned for 5 June, the landings were postponed a day when a storm blew in. Group Captain Stagg's forecast of a brief window on the 6th let Eisenhower say 'OK, let's go'. The Germans, reading the same weather, stood down: Rommel was in Germany for his wife's birthday. The wind also scattered the airborne drops — including Easy's.

Decision: 04:15, 5 June · low tide + moonlight window: 5–7 June

The German defence. Rommel's Atlantic Wall: beach obstacles, mined foreshore, resistance nests, and inland flooding of the Douve and Merderet valleys to drown paratroopers and channel movement. Behind Utah stood the 709th and 91st Divisions and Fallschirmjäger Regiment 6 — Easy's opponents from Brécourt to Carentan. The panzer reserve, held back by Hitler, could not move until the afternoon of 6 June. Utah sector: 709th Inf. Div., 91st Luftlande Div., FJR 6 · Omaha: 352nd Inf. Div.

The airborne assault. Mission Albany (101st) and Boston (82nd) in the west, Tonga (British 6th) in the east: about 23,000 men by parachute and glider. Cloud, flak and evasive flying scattered the Americans across the Cotentin — the confusion that cost Easy its commander and made Winters's D-Day. The scatter also confused the Germans, who could not tell where the main drop was. 101st: DZs A, C, D behind Utah · 82nd: Sainte-Mère-Église and the Merderet · 6th: Orne bridges and Merville

The beaches — five very different battles. Utah: 4th Division ashore on the wrong beach, lightly opposed, ≈200 casualties — because the airborne had the exits and the guns (Brécourt among them) were being silenced. Omaha: bluffs, the 352nd Division and no working armour — ≈2,400 casualties and a crisis until noon. Gold, Juno and Sword: British and Canadian landings that reached furthest inland, though Caen was not taken. H-Hour: Utah/Omaha 06:30 · Gold 07:25 · Sword 07:25 · Juno 07:45–07:55

Naval and air power. Battleships and cruisers bombarded the coast from 05:30; thousands of bombers hit batteries and beaches (missing most of Omaha's defences in the cloud). Allied air supremacy meant the Luftwaffe barely appeared and German reinforcements moved only at night — which is why German formations arrived piecemeal and the concentrated counter-blows the invasion plan feared never came. Bombardment from 05:30 · Rangers scaled Pointe du Hoc at 07:10

Logistics — the artificial harbours. Two prefabricated Mulberry harbours were towed across the Channel and working within days. The great storm of 19–22 June wrecked the American one at Omaha; the British harbour at Arromanches carried on. Fuel came ashore in tankers, jerrycans and short shore pipelines; the first cross-Channel PLUTO line was not laid until August and mattered only after Normandy. The build-up race was won by supply as much as by fighting. Arromanches harbour: ≈2.5 million men, 500,000 vehicles and 4 million tons of supplies over its ten months of operation (not the Normandy campaign alone)

The campaign after D-Day. Carentan (12 June) joined Utah to Omaha; the Cotentin was cut on 18 June and Cherbourg fell on 26–27 June; Caen was finally cleared in July; Operation Cobra broke out on 25 July and the Falaise pocket closed on 21 August. Paris was liberated on 25 August. Easy Company was back in England by then, rebuilding for Holland. Normandy campaign: 6 June – 25 August 1944 · Allied casualties ≈209,000

KEY INVASION SITES

1 Utah Beach

HIGH Beach · US 4th Division

The westernmost beach; the current pushed the first wave south onto a weaker sector and Brig. Gen. Roosevelt chose to 'start the war from right here'. ≈200 casualties — the airborne had the exits.

What you can see: Museum and monuments on the dunes; walk out to the water, then look inland at the causeways.

GPS 49.41520, -1.17640

Read more: Utah Beach Museum (official) · Wikipedia: Utah Beach · US Army CMH: Utah Beach to Cherbourg

2 Crisbecq (Marcouf) Battery

HIGH Battery · German coastal artillery

Heavy 210 mm naval battery that dueled with the fleet off Utah and was not taken until 12 June. Shows the scale of gun the Brécourt battery was a small cousin of.

What you can see: Casemates and museum north of Utah Beach.

GPS 49.47992, -1.29672

3 Azeville Battery

HIGH Battery · German coastal artillery

Four casemates linked by tunnels, painted to look like houses; fired on Utah and held out until 9 June.

What you can see: Walkable tunnels; pair with Crisbecq.

GPS 49.46100, -1.30600

4 Sainte-Mère-Église

HIGH Airborne · 82nd Division

The first town liberated in France, before dawn on 6 June, by the 505th PIR — the centre of the American airborne story.

What you can see: Church, square and Airborne Museum.

GPS 49.40890, -1.31810

Read more: Airborne Museum (official) · Wikipedia: Sainte-Mère-Église · Wikipedia: Mission Boston (82nd drop)

5 La Fière causeway

HIGH Airborne · 82nd Division

Three days of fighting for the Merderet crossing, 6–9 June — the costliest small-unit action of the American airborne assault.

What you can see: Iron Mike statue overlooks the causeway.

GPS 49.40137, -1.36335

6 Pointe du Hoc

HIGH Rangers · 2nd Ranger Battalion

225 Rangers scaled the 30 m cliffs at 07:10 to find the guns moved inland; they found and destroyed them anyway and held out for two days.

What you can see: Cratered ground and casemates; visitor centre under restoration in 2026.

GPS 49.39630, -0.98940

Read more: ABMC: Pointe du Hoc (official) · Wikipedia: Pointe du Hoc

7 Omaha Beach — Vierville draw

HIGH Beach · US 1st & 29th Divisions

The bloodiest beach: bluffs, the veteran 352nd Division, drowned tanks and a first wave pinned at the water's edge. ≈2,400 casualties; the beach was in doubt until midday.

What you can see: National Guard monument on the German casemate at the draw.

GPS 49.37917, -0.90286

8 Normandy American Cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · Colleville-sur-Mer

9,389 American graves above Omaha, including 45 sets of brothers and 3 Medal of Honor recipients.

What you can see: Allow the full time; visitor centre explains the whole campaign.

GPS 49.35920, -0.85730

9 Longues-sur-Mer Battery

HIGH Battery · between Omaha and Gold

Four 150 mm naval guns in casemates that engaged the fleet on the morning of 6 June until silenced by HMS Ajax and the French cruiser Georges Leygues.

What you can see: The only battery with its original guns still in place.

GPS 49.34300, -0.69460

10 Arromanches — Gold Beach

HIGH Beach · British 50th Division

Gold's assault force pushed to the edge of Bayeux by nightfall; the Mulberry B harbour built here fed the whole British front.

What you can see: Harbour remains visible at low tide; museum on the seafront.

GPS 49.33940, -0.62070

11 British Normandy Memorial

HIGH Memorial · Ver-sur-Mer

22,442 names of those under British command who died from D-Day to the end of August.

What you can see: Above Gold Beach; free.

GPS 49.33850, -0.53750

Read more: British Normandy Memorial (official) · Wikipedia: Gold Beach

12 Juno Beach Centre — Courseulles

HIGH Beach · Canadian 3rd Division

The Canadians took the heaviest losses of the British beaches in the first hour, then advanced further inland than any other force on D-Day.

What you can see: Canada's museum on the beach; German bunkers in the dunes.

GPS 49.33730, -0.46000

13 Bény-sur-Mer Canadian Cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · Reviers

2,048 Canadian graves from Juno and the fighting for Caen.

What you can see: Quiet, rarely crowded.

GPS 49.30373, -0.45057

14 Hillman fortress — Colleville-Montgomery

HIGH Strongpoint · Sword sector

The German regimental HQ bunker complex that held up the Suffolks for most of D-Day and helped stop Sword's advance on Caen.

What you can see: Restored bunkers; open on set days.

GPS 49.26528, -0.31003

15 Sword Beach — Ouistreham

HIGH Beach · British 3rd Division & Commandos

Lord Lovat's commandos landed here with a piper playing and marched to relieve Pegasus Bridge by early afternoon. The Grand Bunker — the German fire-control tower — is now a museum.

What you can see: Grand Bunker museum and the Kieffer commando memorial.

GPS 49.28570, -0.25530

16 Pegasus Bridge

HIGH Airborne · British 6th Division

Captured in ten minutes by glider troops at 00:16 — the first action of D-Day.

What you can see: Museum closed until May 2027; bridge and café Gondrée viewable.

GPS 49.24200, -0.27450

17 Ranville War Cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · British 6th Airborne

2,236 graves, mostly of the airborne division, beside the first village liberated by the British.

What you can see: Next to Ranville church; free.

GPS 49.23250, -0.25850

18 Merville Battery

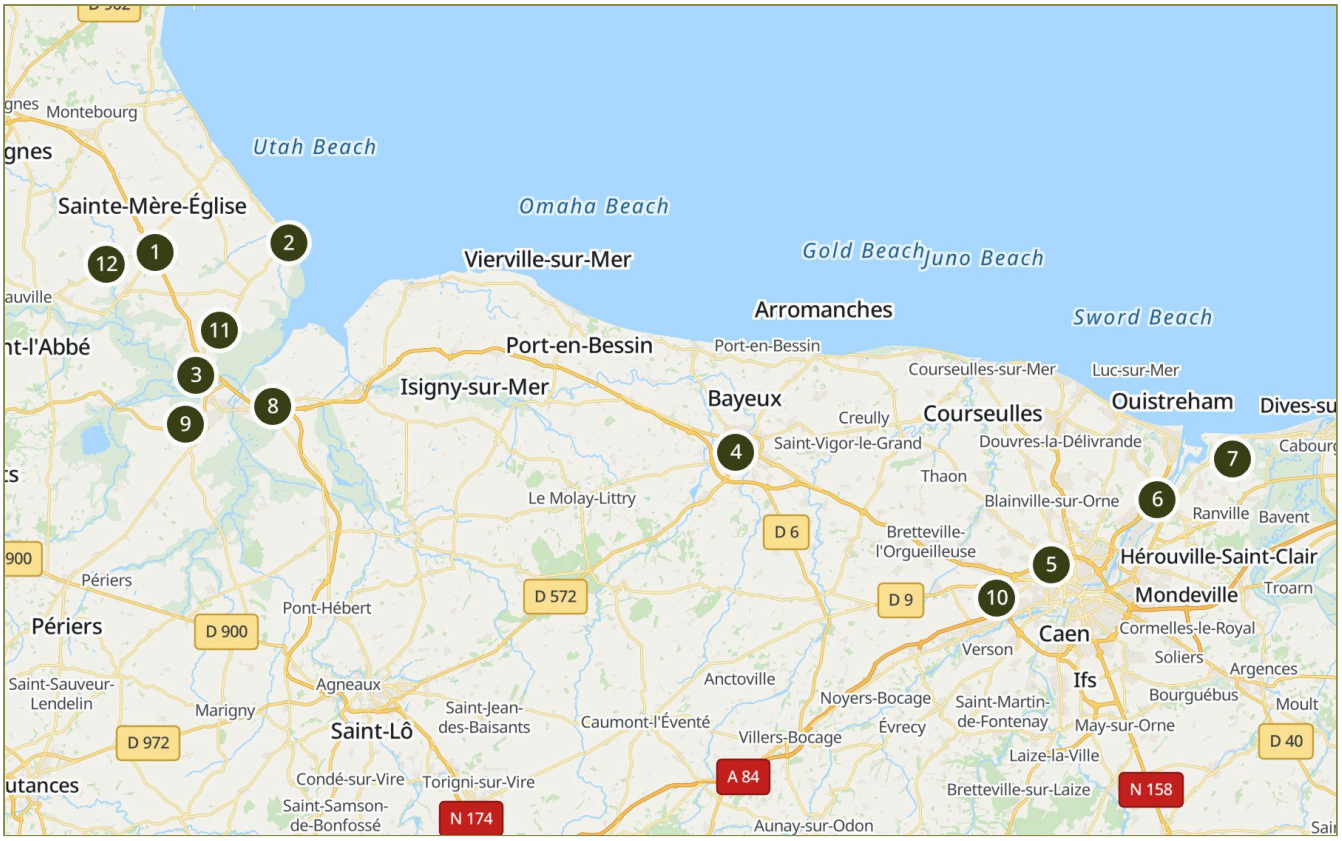
HIGH Battery · British 9th Para Battalion

Taken at 04:30 by 150 scattered paratroopers — Brécourt's British twin.

What you can see: Museum in the casemates.

GPS 49.26940, -0.19650

MUSEUMS



1 Airborne Museum
2 Utah Beach Landing Museum
3 D-Day Experience / Dead Man's Corner
4 Museum of the Battle of Normandy
5 Caen Memorial
6 Memorial Pegasus
7 Merville Battery
8 Normandy Victory Museum
9 Musée Mémorial de Bloody Gulch
10 D-Day Wings Museum
11 Angoville-au-Plain church
12 Iron Mike / La Fière

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

The museums worth your time on this part of the route. Check opening days before you travel.

1 Airborne Museum

Sainte-Mère-Église · Day 1 · 2 hr · at opening

The night drop made physical: C-47, Waco glider, equipment. Best place to grasp what a 'stick' meant.

GPS 49.40870, -1.31740

Read more: Official site · D-Day Center overview

2 Utah Beach Landing Museum

Utah Beach · Day 1 · 1.5–2 hr

The seaborne half of D-Day; beach exits and artillery threats explain Brécourt. B-26 Marauder.

GPS 49.41520, -1.17640

3 D-Day Experience / Dead Man's Corner

Saint-Côme-du-Mont · Day 2 · 1.5 hr

101st and the approach to Carentan; Meehan C-47 material has been shown here; C-47 simulator.

GPS 49.32870, -1.26880

4 Museum of the Battle of Normandy

Bayeux · Day 3 · 1.5–2 hr

The whole campaign after D-Day — places Easy's June in the bigger picture.

GPS 49.27410, -0.71200

5 Caen Memorial

Caen · Day 5 · 3–4 hr

Strategic and human frame of the war, occupation and liberation.

GPS 49.19790, -0.38470

6 Memorial Pegasus

Ranville / Bénouville · Day 5 · Exterior only

British 6th Airborne; original bridge in the grounds. Closed Sep 2026 – May 2027.

GPS 49.24200, -0.27450

7 Merville Battery

Merville-Franceville · Day 5 · 1.5 hr

Airborne assault on a battery — Brécourt's twin.

GPS 49.26940, -0.19650

8 Normandy Victory Museum

Catz (near Carentan) · Extra · Day 2 · Optional

Hedgerow fighting and daily soldier/civilian life — Easy's world 13–28 June.

GPS 49.30496, -1.19286

9 Musée Mémorial de Bloody Gulch

Méautis · Extra · Day 2 · Optional

The fighting after Carentan — the 13 June counterattack Easy helped repel.

GPS 49.29721, -1.28213

10 D-Day Wings Museum

Bretteville-sur-Odon (Caen) · Extra · Day 5 · Optional

Aviation context — the aircraft and crews that carried the airborne divisions.

GPS 49.17531, -0.44130

11 Angoville-au-Plain church

Angoville-au-Plain · Timeline 10 · Free

Easy's reserve sector 7–10 June; the airborne aid station where medics treated both sides.

GPS 49.34930, -1.25330

12 Iron Mike / La Fière

La Fière · Day 2 · Always open

82nd Airborne statue over the causeway and Merderet flood plain.

GPS 49.40137, -1.36335

PEOPLE

THE COMPANY'S WAR IN BRIEF

Easy Company was one of the first American rifle companies built entirely from paratrooper volunteers. It fought from the night drop into Normandy to the end of the war in the Alps, and it lost 48 men killed along the way (the Winters/Ambrose count; other rosters give 49).

Toccoa, 1942–43. Company E of the 506th Parachute Infantry was formed at Camp Toccoa, Georgia, in summer 1942 under 1st Lt. Herbert Sobel, who was soon promoted captain. Most of its men came straight from civilian life. They ran Currahee Mountain — "three miles up, three miles down" — until only the toughest were left, then trained at Benning, Mackall and Bragg before sailing for England in September 1943.

England, 1943–44. The company trained at Aldbourne, Wiltshire. Sobel's clash with his platoon leader Richard Winters led almost every sergeant to hand in his stripes. Sobel was moved out and 1st Lt. Thomas Meehan took command.

Normandy, June–July 1944. Easy jumped behind Utah Beach on the night of 5–6 June. Meehan's plane was shot down and everyone aboard was killed, so Winters took command. That morning he led about a dozen men against the guns at Brécourt Manor. Easy then fought at Carentan and Bloody Gulch and sailed back to England in July.

Holland, September–November 1944. Easy jumped into Holland on 17 September for Market Garden. It entered Eindhoven, was thrown back at Nuenen, and spent weeks on "the Island" between the rivers. On 5 October Winters led the crossroads attack and was then promoted to battalion executive officer. The company helped rescue about 138 Allied soldiers, mostly British airborne troops, in Operation Pegasus.

Bastogne, December 1944–January 1945. Rushed to the Ardennes with too little winter clothing and ammunition, Easy held the edge of the Bois Jacques above Foy. Shelling cost the company Toye's and Guarnere's legs and the lives of Muck and Penkala. On 13 January Lt. Ronald Speirs took over in the middle of the attack on Foy, and the company went on to Noville and Rachamps.

Haguenau and Germany, 1945. Easy held the Moder river in Alsace in February 1945. It then watched the Ruhr pocket from the Rhine and moved into Bavaria, where on 28–29 April it entered a Kaufering sub-camp near Landsberg (probably Kaufering IV). On 5 May it reached Berchtesgaden and the Obersalzberg.

Austria and home, 1945. After Germany surrendered, Easy occupied Zell am See and Kaprun in Austria. It moved to France in the summer to train for Japan, but the war ended first. The 101st Airborne was inactivated on 30 November 1945.

THE OFFICERS

Richard D. Winters "Dick" — Platoon leader, company commander, then battalion commander. Born 21 Jan 1918, New Holland, Pennsylvania · died 2 Jan 2011, Campbelltown, Pennsylvania

An economics graduate of Franklin & Marshall College, Winters joined Easy at Toccoa in 1942 as a platoon leader. When Lt. Meehan was killed on D-Day he took command, and that morning led about a dozen men against the four guns at Brécourt Manor. He was recommended for the Medal of Honor and received the Distinguished Service Cross. He was wounded at Carentan and led the crossroads attack in Holland on 5 October 1944, then became battalion executive officer and later its commander, ending the war as a major. Calm, sober and devout, he was the man Easy trusted most.

Decorations: Distinguished Service Cross — leading the attack on the guns at Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944 (he had been recommended for the Medal of Honor); Bronze Star — reason not recorded (some records show a second); Purple Heart — wounded in the leg at Carentan, June 1944.

After the war: Worked for the Nixon family firm, then ran his own animal-feed business in Hershey. Wrote a memoir with Col. Cole Kingseed (2006).

Lewis Nixon III “Nix” — Battalion intelligence officer, Winters' closest friend. Born 30 Sep 1918, New York City · died 11 Jan 1995, Los Angeles

The wealthy, Yale-educated son of an industrial family, Nixon was never in Easy itself but served on 2nd Battalion staff beside it from Toccoa onward. He jumped into Normandy and Holland, where a bullet grazed his forehead. In March 1945 he jumped with the 17th Airborne in Operation Varsity; his plane was hit and only four men got out. He drank heavily during the war, and Winters stood by him throughout.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded (some sources say two); Parachute wings with three combat-jump stars — Normandy, Holland and Operation Varsity, a rare set.

After the war: Brought Winters into the family business; later remarried and gave up drinking.

Herbert M. Sobel — Easy's first commander. Born 26 Jan 1912, Chicago · died 30 Sep 1987, Waukegan, Illinois

Sobel built Easy at Toccoa and drove it relentlessly: extra runs, harsh punishments, cancelled passes. His men found him petty and doubted his judgement in the field. When he court-martialled Winters in England, nearly every sergeant offered to give up his stripes, and he was moved out in early 1944. He went on to run a parachute school and later served as the regiment's supply officer, and he jumped on D-Day. Several veterans later credited him with making Easy as tough as it was.

Decorations: Bronze Star — no citation survives; one account links it to D-Day, when he and four men knocked out a German machine-gun nest with grenades.

After the war: Worked in Chicago as a credit manager; spent his last years in a veterans' home.

Thomas Meehan III — Company commander, Feb–June 1944. Born 8 Jul 1921, Philadelphia · killed in action 6 Jun 1944, near Beuzeville-au-Plain, Normandy

A Philadelphia art student who transferred to Easy from B Company, Meehan took command after Sobel left. On D-Day he led the company headquarters in C-47 "Chalk 66". The plane was hit by flak and crashed near Beuzeville-au-Plain; everyone aboard was killed, including 1st Sgt. William Evans. Easy did not learn his fate until long after. The wreck was found in the early 1950s and reportedly excavated in 1989; a memorial now marks the site.

Ronald C. Speirs “Sparky” — Easy's longest-serving commander, Jan 1945 to the end. Born 20 Apr 1920, Edinburgh, Scotland · died 11 Apr 2007, Montana

Brought up in Boston, Speirs fought in Normandy with D Company, including at Brécourt, and was wounded. He won the Silver Star in Holland for a solo patrol across the Lower Rhine. On 13 January 1945, in the attack on Foy, Winters sent him to take over Easy mid-battle; he famously ran through the German-held village to reach I Company and back. He led Easy through Haguenau, Germany and Austria. Stories that he shot prisoners were never confirmed.

Decorations: Silver Star — swam the Lower Rhine (Neder Rijn) alone near Randwijk to scout German positions and came back with a captured boat, 10 October 1944, wounded on the way back; Bronze Star — reason not recorded (number not confirmed); Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — wounded in Normandy, June 1944, and in Holland, 10 October 1944; Legion of Merit — after the war, for service from October 1961 to March 1964, a period that included Laos.

After the war: Stayed in the Army — Korea, US governor of Spandau Prison in Berlin, Laos; retired a lieutenant colonel.

Lynn Compton “Buck” — Platoon leader. Born 31 Dec 1921, Los Angeles · died 25 Feb 2012, Burlington, Washington

A UCLA catcher and Rose Bowl footballer, Compton won the Silver Star at Brécourt Manor. He was shot through the buttocks in Holland and came back to lead his platoon at Bastogne. After watching his friends Toye and Guarnere lose their legs in January 1945, he was evacuated with severe trench foot.

Decorations: Silver Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — shot through the buttocks in Holland, September 1944.

After the war: Police detective, then prosecutor who led the case against Robert Kennedy's assassin, Sirhan Sirhan (1969); California appeals court judge 1970–90.

Harry F. Welsh “Welshy” — Platoon leader, later executive officer. Born 27 Sep 1918, Pennsylvania · died 21 Jan 1995, Wilkes-Barre, Pennsylvania

A former enlisted paratrooper who reportedly won and lost his sergeant's stripes several times for fighting, Welsh went to officer school and joined Easy. He led 1st Platoon into Carentan and was wounded at Bastogne at Christmas 1944, returning in 1945. He was Winters' closest friend in the company.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — one for the mortar wound at Bastogne, Christmas 1944; the other wound is not recorded.

After the war: Married Kitty Grogan, a friend of Winters, in a wedding dress made from parachute silk; taught at GAR and Coughlin high schools in Wilkes-Barre, then was Director of Pupil Services for the Wilkes-Barre Area School District until 1983.

Frederick Heyliger “Moose” — Company commander, Oct 1944. Born 23 Jun 1916, Acton, Massachusetts · died 3 Nov 2001, Concord, Massachusetts

A big, well-liked former mortar platoon leader, Heyliger took command of Easy when Winters moved up in October 1944. He led the company in Operation Pegasus, the night rescue across the Rhine of about 138 Allied soldiers, mostly British, and received the British Military Cross. On 31 October he was badly wounded by one of his own sentries while checking the line with Winters, and he did not return.

Decorations: British Military Cross — leading Operation Pegasus, the rescue of about 138 Allied evaders, mostly British, night of 22–23 October 1944; Bronze Star — citation not found; Purple Heart — shot by his own sentry on the Island, 31 October 1944.

After the war: Studied horticulture at the University of Massachusetts.

Norman S. Dike Jr. “Foxhole Norman” — Company commander, Nov 1944 – 13 Jan 1945. Born 19 May 1918, Brooklyn, New York · died 23 Jun 1989, Rolle, Switzerland

A Brown graduate and Yale law student, Dike came from regimental staff to command Easy after Heyliger. The men felt he was rarely seen on the line, hence the nickname, yet he earned two Bronze Stars, one for carrying wounded men to safety at Bastogne. During the attack on Foy on 13 January 1945 the advance stalled and Winters replaced him with Speirs. Why it stalled is disputed (see the notes at the end).

Decorations: Bronze Star — rallying scattered paratroopers to hold the road junction at Uden, Holland, while surrounded, 23–25 September 1944; Bronze Star (second award) — carrying three wounded men out of an exposed position under fire at Bastogne, 3 January 1945; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — one reportedly for a shoulder wound at Foy, 13 January 1945.

After the war: Yale law degree, work in Japan and for the CIA, then a legal and business career; lived in Switzerland from 1960.

THE SERGEANTS

C. Carwood Lipton “Lip” — First sergeant, later lieutenant. Born 30 Jan 1920, Huntington, West Virginia · died 16 Dec 2001, North Carolina

His father was killed and his mother paralysed in a car crash when he was ten. Lipton enlisted in 1942 and was one of Easy's first privates. He fought at Brécourt Manor, was wounded at Carentan, and became first sergeant — the man who held the company together at Bastogne while its officers failed or fell. After Foy he was commissioned a lieutenant in the field, and he served through Germany and Austria.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944, where he climbed a tree to fire into the German position (some records show a second Bronze Star); Purple Heart — shell fragments to the face and groin at Carentan, June 1944; his headstone records two more, for three in all.

After the war: Engineering degree from Marshall; a long career with the glassmaker Owens-Illinois.

William Guarnere “Wild Bill” — 2nd Platoon sergeant. Born 28 Apr 1923, South Philadelphia · died 8 Mar 2014, Philadelphia

The youngest of ten in an Italian-American family, Guarnere built Sherman tanks before enlisting. He jumped into Normandy knowing his brother had just been killed in Italy, and fought with fury at Brécourt Manor, earning the Silver Star. Shot in the leg in Holland, he slipped out of hospital to rejoin the company. On 3 January 1945 near Foy he lost a leg to shellfire while helping the wounded Joe Toye.

Decorations: Silver Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart (two) — a sniper's bullet in the leg on the Island, October 1944, and the loss of his leg near Foy, 3 January 1945.

After the war: Veterans' advocate; co-wrote Brothers in Battle, Best of Friends (2007) with Babe Heffron. Statues of him stand in Pennsylvania.

Donald G. Malarkey — Mortar sergeant. Born 31 Jul 1921, Astoria, Oregon · died 30 Sep 2017, Salem, Oregon

A University of Oregon student from the Columbia River coast, Malarkey fought at Brécourt and then in every Easy campaign. He is said to have spent more continuous time on the line than anyone in the company without being seriously wounded. The death of his close friends Skip Muck and Alex Penkala at Bastogne stayed with him all his life.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; a second Bronze Star, reason not recorded; Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded; French Legion of Honour — awarded in 2009 as a surviving veteran of the liberation of France.

After the war: County commissioner in Oregon; wrote Easy Company Soldier (2008).

Joseph Toye “Joe” — Squad leader. Born 14 Mar 1919, Hughestown, Pennsylvania · died 3 Sep 1995, Reading, Pennsylvania

A coal miner's son who left school to work in the mines, Toye was known as one of the toughest men in the company. He fought at Brécourt, was wounded in Holland and again at Bastogne, and on 3 January 1945 lost his right leg to shellfire in the Bois Jacques. He had more wounds than almost anyone in Easy.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Purple Hearts — three or four (sources differ; a local marker calls it the most in Easy): shellfire in Holland, autumn 1944; wounds at Bastogne; and the loss of his leg near Foy, 3 January 1945.

After the war: Worked at the Grace iron mine for Bethlehem Steel. Winters gave his eulogy.

Floyd Talbert “Tab” — Squad leader, briefly first sergeant. Born 26 Aug 1923, Howard County, Indiana · died Oct 1982, Shasta Lake, California

Talbert was wounded in Normandy, reportedly by an Easy man who mistook him in the dark for a German. He came back to serve in Holland and at Bastogne and was made first sergeant, a job he later gave up to return to his men. Winters rated him among the finest soldiers in the company.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — most likely for the bayonet wound in Normandy, June 1944.

After the war: Worked in industry and farming; lost touch with Easy until a reunion in 1981.

Denver Randleman “Bull” — Squad leader. Born 20 Nov 1920, Rector, Arkansas · died 26 Jun 2003

A big, quiet Arkansan and former foundry worker, Randleman fought in Normandy and at Carentan. At Nuenen in Holland in September 1944 he was wounded and cut off; he hid in a barn, killed a German soldier who found him, and rejoined the company the next day. He went on through Bastogne, Foy and Haguenau.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — shoulder wound from a tank shell in Holland, September 1944, the fight in which he hid in the barn.

After the war: Service manager for a Caterpillar dealer, then construction superintendent in Louisiana.

Warren Muck “Skip” — Sergeant, mortar squad. Born 31 Jan 1922, Tonawanda, New York · killed in action 10 Jan 1945, Bois Jacques, near Foy, Belgium

A cheerful young man from upstate New York and Malarkey's closest friend, Muck jumped into Normandy and Holland. On 10 January 1945 a shell struck the foxhole he shared with Pvt. Alex Penkala in the Bois Jacques, killing both. Both are buried in the Luxembourg American Cemetery at Hamm.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart (posthumous) — killed in the Bois Jacques, 10 January 1945.

Darrell Powers “Shifty” — Rifleman and marksman, later staff sergeant. Born 13 Mar 1923, Clinchco, Virginia · died 17 Jun 2009, Bristol, Tennessee

Raised hunting in the Appalachian hills, Powers was one of Easy's best shots. At Bastogne he noticed a "tree that wasn't there yesterday" — a hidden German position — and at Foy he killed a sniper. He was never wounded in combat, but after winning the lottery for a trip home in 1945 he was badly hurt when his truck crashed on the way.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded.

After the war: Machinist, then more than 20 years with Clinchfield Coal; married to Dorothy for about 60 years.

THE MEN

Edward Heffron “Babe” — Machine gunner. Born 16 May 1923, South Philadelphia · died 1 Dec 2013, Stratford, New Jersey

A shipyard worker from an Irish Catholic family, Heffron joined Easy as a replacement in England after Normandy. He jumped into Holland and fought at Bastogne, where in late December 1944 he was pinned down trying to reach his dying friend John Julian. He was at a Kaufering sub-camp and in Berchtesgaden in 1945. He and Bill Guarnere, from the same neighbourhood, stayed best friends for life.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Bastogne, winter 1944–45 (the action is not recorded); Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded.

After the war: Worked at a whiskey distillery and then on the Philadelphia docks; co-wrote Brothers in Battle, Best of Friends (2007).

George Luz — Company radio operator. Born 17 Jun 1921, Fall River, Massachusetts · died 15 Oct 1998, West Warwick, Rhode Island

The company's joker, famous for his impressions of officers, Luz carried Easy's radio from Normandy through Holland, Bastogne and into Germany and Austria. His humour kept men going in the worst moments of the siege.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded.

After the war: Maintenance work in Rhode Island; killed in an industrial accident. About 1,600 people came to his funeral.

David Kenyon Webster — Rifleman and writer. Born 2 Jun 1922, New York City · lost at sea 9 Sep 1961, off Santa Monica, California

A Harvard English student who volunteered for the paratroopers, Webster jumped on D-Day with battalion headquarters and joined Easy afterwards. He was shot in the leg on the Island in Holland on 5 October 1944 and rejoined at Haguenau. His clear, often critical writing about the war made him the company's chronicler, and Ambrose drew heavily on it.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — a shell-fragment wound in Normandy, June 1944, and a machine-gun bullet through the leg on the Island, October 1944.

After the war: Journalist. He vanished while sailing alone off Santa Monica in 1961; his memoir Parachute Infantry was published in 1994.

Eugene Roe “Doc” — Medic. Born 17 Oct 1921 or 1922, Bayou Chêne, Louisiana · died 30 Dec 1998, Baton Rouge, Louisiana

A Cajun from St. Martin Parish, Roe was the battalion medic attached to Easy from Normandy to the end of the war. At Bastogne he worked in the snow and cold with almost no supplies, going from foxhole to foxhole under shellfire. His officer recommended him for the Silver Star, which he never received.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Combat Medical Badge.

After the war: Construction contractor in Louisiana.

Joseph Liebgott — Rifleman and German interpreter. Born 17 May 1915, Michigan · died 28 Jun 1992, San Bernardino, California

The son of German-speaking immigrants, Liebgott grew up in the San Francisco Bay Area and worked as a barber. He fought at Brécourt and Carentan, was wounded twice on the Island in Holland, and fought at Bastogne. In 1945 his German made him Easy's interpreter, including at a Kaufering sub-camp. Many of his comrades assumed he was Jewish; his family says he was not.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944.

After the war: Barber in the Bay Area; father of eight.

Albert Blithe — Rifleman. Born 25 Jun 1923, Philadelphia · died 17 Dec 1967, Wiesbaden, West Germany

Blithe jumped into Normandy and, around Carentan, suffered a brief stress-induced blindness. He was then shot by a sniper in the collarbone and shoulder — his Purple Heart is dated 25 June 1944, his 21st birthday — and did not return to Easy. Early accounts said he died of his wounds in 1948; that is wrong.

Decorations: Purple Heart — sniper's bullet in the shoulder near Carentan, 25 June 1944.

After the war: Stayed in the Army; served in Korea with the 187th Airborne, earning a Silver Star, and died on active duty as a master sergeant. Buried at Arlington.

Edward D. Shames — Platoon leader. Born 13 Jun 1922, Norfolk, Virginia · died 3 Dec 2021, Virginia

The son of Jewish immigrants, Shames joined as an I Company paratrooper, became a 3rd Battalion operations sergeant, and received a battlefield commission in Normandy on his 22nd birthday. He joined Easy as a platoon leader, volunteered for the Pegasus rescue, and fought at Bastogne and Foy, where he helped knock out a German tank with a bazooka. At Berchtesgaden in May 1945 he took cognac labelled for Hitler's own use.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — a leg wound (sources give one to three awards).

After the war: Middle East specialist at the National Security Agency; he used the cognac for his son's Bar Mitzvah. He was the last surviving Easy officer.

Walter Gordon “Smokey” — Machine gunner. Born 15 Apr 1920 or 1921, Jackson, Mississippi · died 19 Apr 1997, Mississippi

A college student turned down by the Marines and Navy, Gordon was with Easy from Toccoa. He jumped into Normandy and Holland. On Christmas Eve 1944 at Bastogne a sniper's bullet passed through both shoulders and grazed his spine, paralysing him for a time; he never returned to combat.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — for his wounds at Carentan (13 June 1944) and Bastogne (24 December 1944); records show one award.

After the war: Law degree, then a career as an oil and gas lease broker in Louisiana; organised Easy Company reunions from 1946.

ABOUT THE DECORATIONS

The most decorated single action was Brécourt Manor on D-Day: Winters received the Distinguished Service Cross; Compton, Guarnere and Lt. Lorraine the Silver Star; and Lipton, Malarkey, Toye, Liebgott and several others the Bronze Star.

"Reason not recorded" means no citation survives online. After the war, in 1947, the Army gave a Bronze Star to every soldier who had earned the Combat Infantryman Badge (or the Combat Medical Badge, for medics). That is the likely reason for many of these Bronze Stars, but it is not confirmed for any one man.

Every man here also shared the unit awards, so they are not repeated on each card: the Presidential Unit Citation for Normandy and again for Bastogne, the Dutch Orange Lanyard for Holland, the Belgian Fourragère, and the French Croix de Guerre with palm for Normandy.

Oak leaf cluster = a second (or further) award of the same medal.

WHERE THE SOURCES DISAGREE

These bios follow the best-supported version.

Dike
: Winters, Lipton and most witnesses say he froze at Foy; Clancy Lyall later said he had been hit in the shoulder. This guide says only that the advance stalled.

Speirs
: Stories that he shot German prisoners in Normandy; no eyewitness confirms them.

Sobel
: Remembered as a petty tyrant, but several veterans credit him with making Easy tough; the TV drama leaves out his D-Day jump.

Blithe

Early books and the TV drama said he died of his wounds in 1948 — he died in 1967; the wound was the collarbone/shoulder, not the neck.

Liebgott

Often shown as Jewish; his family says he was not.

Compton

The TV drama showed him as shell-shocked; he blamed trench foot and exhaustion.

Powers

The first edition of Ambrose said he refused a patrol at Bastogne; both he and Shames denied it and it was removed.

Shames

Whether he was among the first into the Eagle's Nest, and whether the cognac came from there or from Hitler's quarters below.

Talbert

Ambrose describes a troubled post-war life; his family disputes it.

Gordon

His first wound: Carentan (June 1944) or near Eindhoven (Holland).

Guarnere

Born 1922 or 1923; right or left leg lost.

Welsh

Wounded Christmas Eve or Christmas Day 1944; born in Audenried or Wilkes-Barre.

Winters

Recommended for the Medal of Honor for Brécourt; received the Distinguished Service Cross instead.

WORDS TO KNOW

E Company — "Easy" Company — about 140 men of the 506th Parachute Infantry Regiment

PIR — Parachute Infantry Regiment — about 2,000 paratroopers

101st — the 101st Airborne Division, "Screaming Eagles"

CP — command post — where the officers ran the fight

DZ — drop zone — the field the paratroopers were meant to land in

Stick — the 15–18 men who jumped from one plane

C-47 — the twin-engine transport plane that carried them

XO — executive officer — the second-in-command

NCO — sergeants and corporals

Flak — anti-aircraft fire

LZ — landing zone

GIR — Glider Infantry Regiment

BAR — automatic rifle

MG — machine gun

HQ — headquarters

OP — lookout post

Fallschirmjäger — German paratroopers

CREDITS

Sources for the company’s origins:
506th Infantry Regiment (Wikipedia)
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101st Airborne Division (Wikipedia)
Robert F. Sink (Wikipedia)
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Currahee Military Museum, Toccoa
Book: Stephen E. Ambrose's 1992 history of Easy Company, chapters 1–4.

Sources: Stephen Ambrose’s history of the company; Winters’ and Webster’s memoirs; TracesOfWar, Hall of Valor, Wikipedia, Find a Grave and obituaries.

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A free DZ Charlie field guide · dzcharlie.com. The phone guide adds the battle story as audio, the weapons of the company, the chain of command and a personal diary of your tour.